

E-commerce Website Requirements (From a Buyer's Perspective)

1. What I Want

I need a modern online store where people can buy my products easily. It should look good, work fast, and be simple to use on phones, tablets, and computers. I want it built with React and Next.js for the front, Node.js and Express.js for the back, and MongoDB to store everything, because I've heard these are solid and future-proof options.

2. Who's Using It

- **Shoppers:** People browsing and buying stuff—some will just look around, others will sign up for an account.
- **Me (the Owner):** I need a way to manage my products and keep an eye on orders.

3. What It Should Do

3.1 For Shoppers

1. Home Page

- Show off my best products right when they land on the site.
- Add a search bar so they can find things quick.
- Make it eye-catching but not cluttered.

2. Product Pages

- List all my products with pictures, prices, and a short description.
- Let them filter by stuff like price or category (e.g., "shirts" or "shoes").
- Each product gets its own page with more details—stock status, bigger pics, and an "Add to Cart" button.

3. Shopping Cart

- Let them add stuff to a cart and see it all in one place.
- Show the total price as they add or remove things.
- If they sign up, save their cart so it's there when they come back.

4. **Checkout**

- Make it easy to pay—ask for their address and payment info (like credit card or PayPal).
- Show them an “Order Confirmed” page when they're done.
- Maybe send them an email saying thanks (would be nice but not a must).

5. **Account Stuff**

- Let people sign up with an email and password, or log in if they've been here before.
- Give them a spot to see their past orders and update their info (like address).

6. **Search**

- If they type something like “blue jacket,” show matching products fast.

3.2 For Me (the Owner)

1. **Admin Area**

- I need a private section where I can log in and:
 - Add new products with names, prices, descriptions, and photos.
 - Edit or delete products if they're sold out or I change my mind.
 - See all the orders—who bought what, where it's going, and if it's shipped yet.
- Maybe let me block a user if they're causing trouble (not urgent).

4. **How It Should Feel**

- **Fast:** I don't want people waiting ages for pages to load—keep it snappy, like under 2 seconds.
- **Safe:** Make sure no one can hack it or steal customer info. Use passwords and secure payment stuff.

- **Easy to Find:** People should find my site on Google—make it “SEO-friendly” or whatever it’s called.
- **Works Everywhere:** It has to look great and work smooth whether they’re on a phone or a laptop.

5. What I’m Selling (Example Data)

- I’ll have products like:
 - T-shirts: \$20, sizes S/M/L, 50 in stock, category “Clothing.”
 - Sneakers: \$50, sizes 7-11, 20 in stock, category “Footwear.”
- Each product needs a name, price, description, picture, and how many I’ve got left.

6. Must-Haves

- **Payment:** Hook it up to something like Stripe or PayPal so people can pay online.
- **Pictures:** I’ll upload product photos—make sure they show up nice and clear.
- **Stock:** If something’s out of stock, tell the customer right away.

7. Nice-to-Haves (If There’s Time)

- **Reviews:** Let buyers rate products (like 5 stars) and write a quick note.
- **Wishlist:** A button to save stuff they like for later.
- **Email Alerts:** Tell them when their order ships or if I’ve got a sale.

8. How It Should Get Built

- **Front Part:** Use React and Next.js so it’s fast and looks modern.
- **Back Part:** Node.js with Express.js to handle the behind-the-scenes stuff.
- **Storage:** MongoDB to keep track of products, orders, and customers.
- **Steps:**
 1. Start with the basics—home page, product list, and cart.
 2. Add the checkout and account stuff next.
 3. Finish with my admin tools.

- Test it a bunch to make sure it doesn't break when people use it.

9. When and Where

- I'd love to see it live in a month or two—nothing crazy fancy, just working.
- Put it online somewhere easy like Vercel (I heard it's good for Next.js) and maybe Heroku for the backend.

10. Budget Thoughts

- I'm not a millionaire, so keep it simple but solid. If extras like reviews cost more, let me know, and I'll decide later.